

EVOLUTION OF MUSLIM NATIONALISM

PART II

**ARRIVAL OF EUROPEANS TO WAR OF
INDEPENDENCE 1857**

ADVENT OF EUROPEANS IN SUBCONTINENT

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- Riches, wealth and splendor of Subcontinent attracted foreigners. Europeans entered in East for trade and business but soon became masters of Subcontinent. All Empires encouraged trade between East and West.
 - Commercial necessity forced Europeans to start business cycle in India. English merchants formed East India Company (EIC) in December 1600 AD while actual pioneers behind European establishment were Portuguese, who first discover the sea route to India.

EAST INDIA COMPANY

- In 1608 sent Captain Hawkins to access the possibilities of commercial contacts with India. He succeeded in getting permission from Mughal emperor but was strongly opposed by Portuguese and Surat merchants.
- However, Jahangir granted EIC business charter and they established factory at Surat. In this way, they established their foothold as traders and gradually extended their influence.
- EIC started building many factories in India like in Agra, Ahmadabad, Borach (Gujrat), Orissa, Hugli (West Bengal), Dacca, Patna and Sutanti (Bengal).

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- Establishment in Sutanti proved a foundation stone of future capital of British India. In 1698 they were granted the permission of zamindari of Eastern Bengal.
 - In 1700, they built fortified settlements named as Fort William.
 - In spite of political disorders of India, the expansion of East India Company's trade and influence was quiet and gradual during the first forty years of 18th century.

EAST INDIA COMPANY AND DECLINE OF MUSLIM RULE

- From 7th to 17th century, Muslims had built great empires and organized administrative systems and unmatched cultural traditions. They had supreme powers over Mediterranean and Red sea, extending trade relations to Asia, Africa and Europe.
- But after demise of Alamgir, Mughals were caught in wars of succession. Gauging this situation, many non-muslim groups started their activities against muslim rule.
- Mughals focused ousting Portuguese out of India but did not pay attention to increasing trends of European immigrants.

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- By the 18th century French and British were two emerging powers in India. European merchants were well on road to prosperity while Mughal power was declining.
 - EIC started to establish factories and gradually planned to rule India, whereas Muslims lost sense of responsibility. They never tried to built their naval might.
 - Freedom of entry led British to carry on their acquisitive activities and they became so powerful that no one could challenge them.

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- During the wars of 18th century , the British factories served as collection and transshipment point on one hand and on other as fortified centers of refuge.
 - British gradually began to apply British law to disputes arising within their jurisdiction. British and French became involved in local politics in south and Bengal.
 - Battle of Plassey 1757, and treachery of Mir Jafar established the EIC as the ruler of Bengal for all practical purposes.

TRANSITION PHASE

FROM COMPANY RULE TO CROWN RULE

- British government in subcontinent was not a result of fight between two forces but it was a long term strategy of English from the time they realized the instability of Mughals.
- The patterns of territorial acquisition and rule as applied by the company in Sindh and Punjab and the manner of their governance became the foundation of British rule in British Indian Empire and indirectly in the princely states.
- Hence the company rule was transferred into Crown rule.

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- The area controlled by company expanded during the first three decades by two methods.
 - **SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCES**: It was agreement between British and the local rulers, under which the control of foreign affairs, defence and communications was transferred from the ruler to the EIC and consequently the rulers were allowed to rule. This development created what came to be called as Native States or Princely India, Maharaja (Hindu rulers) and Nawab (Muslim rulers).

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- **ANNEXATION OF TERRITORIES:** This second reason was outright military conquest or direct annexation of areas. Most of the Northern India was annexed by the British and it was these territories that were called as British India.
- India was divided into two types of regimes, one was directly ruled by British governors and other was indirectly assisted by British resident. However, owing to the British policies, Indians resented the British supremacy and some of them united but in a disorganized way and staged a revolt against the British that shook their rule in Subcontinent.

CAUSES OF WAR OF INDEPENDENCE 1857

➤ POLITICAL CAUSES

- Policy of expansion
- Doctrine of Lapse
- Annoyance of rulers of State
- Confiscation of Estates

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➤ **ECONOMIC CAUSES OF THE WAR**

- New Agrarian Policy
- Destruction of Local Industry
- Permanent Settlement
- Unemployment
- Domination of trade by the English
- Court Fee Stamps

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➤ **RELIGIOUS CAUSES**

- Propagation of Christianity
- Introduction of new inventions
- Jihad Movement
- Anti-religion Laws

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➤ **SOCIAL CAUSES**

- Mockery of cultural heritage
- Insulting treatment with the people

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➤ **MILITARY CAUSES**

- Disbanded armies of annexed states
- Dearth of English troops
- Greased cartridges

CAUSES OF FAILURE OF WAR

- Lack of Leadership and Discipline
- Lack of unity
- Lack of Resources
- Lack of Popular Support
- Superior Technology of English troops
- Non-cooperation of the rulers of the State

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- Non-Cooperation of Sikhs of Punjab
 - Role of traitors
 - Return of British troops from Crimea

RESULTS OF THE REVOLT

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- The great uprising of 1857 was an important landmark in the history of modern India. The revolt marked the end of the East India Company's rule in India. India now came under the direct rule of the British Crown. Thus, Indian administration was taken over by Queen Victoria, which, in effect, meant the British Parliament. The Governor General's office was replaced by that of the Viceroy.
 - The Doctrine of Lapse was abolished. The right to adopt sons as legal heirs was accepted. The Revolt of 1857 paved the way for the future struggle for freedom in India.

THE SEEDS OF MUSLIM NATIONALISM

- Muslims fell from the height of dignity, social prestige, prosperity, rich culture and traditions to the depths of humiliation and worst poverty.
- Hindus maintained their traditional shrewdness and rebellion and presented Muslims as a source of rebellion to British. Resultantly, British saw muslim community as a source of chronic danger and threat to British power in India.
- Post 1857 period witnessed anti Muslim policies by Britishers that further aggravated the economic collapse of Muslim community.

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- Worse still, all avenues of employment were closed upon them, they remained humbled, frustrated and persecuted.
 - A vacuum was created by the collapse of Muslim rule and its law of the nature that whenever there is demand there is supply.
 - Sir Syed rose in these circumstances who devoted his life for the rehabilitation of Muslims of India. His dream was to recover the lost political, social, cultural and economic status of Muslims. He sowed the seeds of Muslim nationalism in India where the destiny of Muslims was shaped as a **“Nation with Future”**.